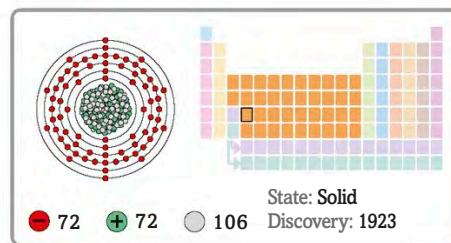


72
Hf

Hafnium



Forms

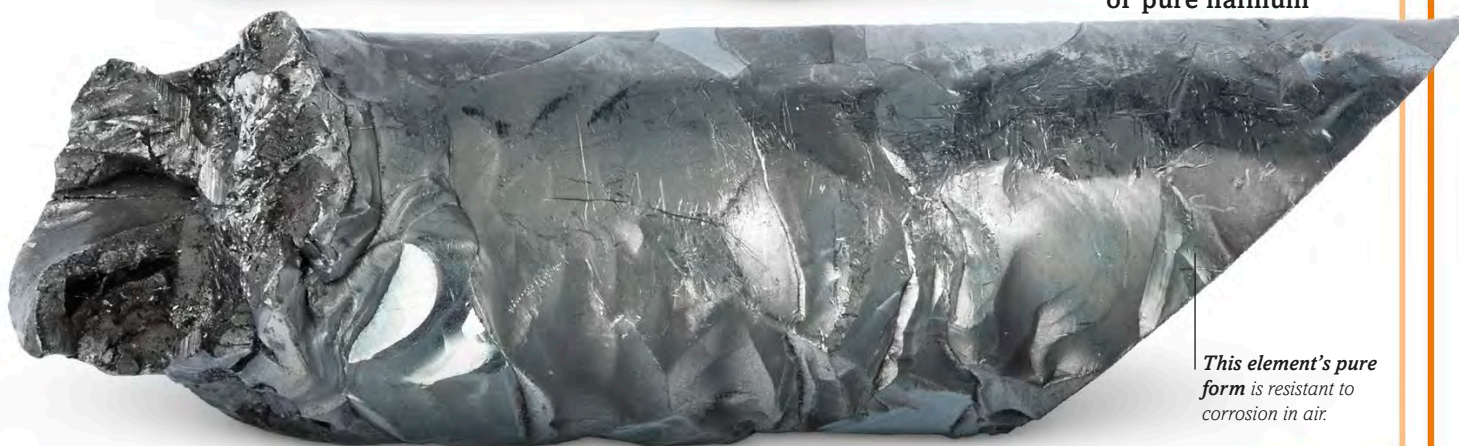


Zircon crystals

Hafnium uses up 4% of the mass of this zircon crystal.

A zircon crystal can be up to **4 billion years** old.

Laboratory sample of pure hafnium



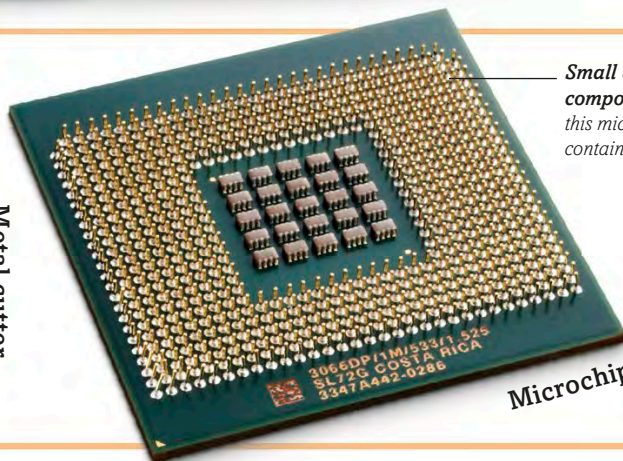
This element's pure form is resistant to corrosion in air.

Uses



Sections of this cutter are made of hafnium.

Metal cutter



Small electronic components in this microchip contain hafnium.

Microchip

Hafnium is named after *Hafnia*, the Latin word for the city of Copenhagen in Denmark. It took a long time to distinguish hafnium from zirconium because the two elements are present together in crystals of the mineral **zircon** and their atoms are

similar sizes. Hafnium is used in powerful **cutters** that pierce metallic objects with a hot stream of sparks. It is also used to make ultra-small electronics – only a few millionths of a millimetre wide – in **microchips**.